ENGINEERING CASEBOOK

External results

Code. Investigation. External consequence.

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5 directly merged PRs; 3 contributions incorporated into merged maintainer fixes; 1 audit. 3 observations across 2 arenas/events, with Zoria counted once.

A dated record with public primary sources.

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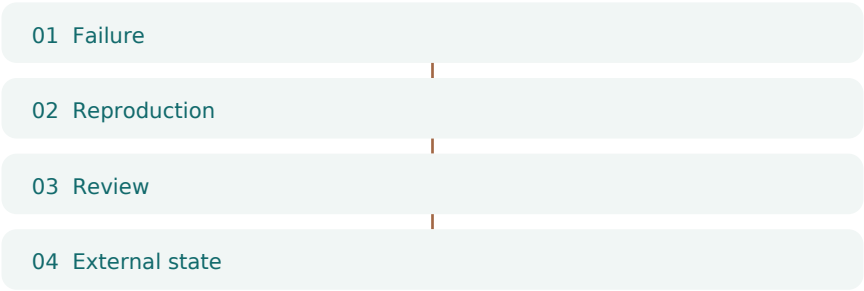
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Role, method and units of evidence

I investigate failures, define contracts and verify consequences. AI tools assist research, implementation and checking; I set direction, take responsibility for engineering decisions and authorize external actions. This book does not measure autonomy percentages or rank AI models.

5 directly merged PRs; 3 contributions incorporated into merged maintainer fixes; 1 audit. 3 observations across 2 arenas/events, with Zoria counted once.



A local test verifies a mechanism. An upstream merge or credit records an external outcome. Neither alone establishes complete CI, adoption or payment.

Dates are stated against UTC. Original timestamp fields remain for historical snapshots; the date an announcement was checked may differ from publication.

01 FilesDrop

2026-10-21 · Direct PR merged

Problem

I started from two lifecycle failures: failed deletion could disappear from the next cleanup batch, and a deadline did not end waiting for DNS. The first problem was loss of retryable work; the second was the boundary between request waiting and the native resolver.

Decision and role

I retained failed items for another pass and committed successful deletions separately. A 501-file counterexample exposed starvation behind one persistent failure. For URL uploads, cancellation ends request waiting while retaining address validation and redirect behavior.

Validation

The regressions first failed on the base. The saved local run passed 236 tests across 12 API suites. Temporary files and DNS/HTTP doubles exercised the intended transitions, rather than a production deployment.

What I carry forward

Cleanup must preserve retryability. Cancelling a wait does not imply stopping the underlying system operation.

External outcome boundary

Merged API fixes with local regression coverage; no production deployment, live service test or payment claimed.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Detailed case

02 Prime Intellect

2026-10-24 · Incorporated into a merged maintainer fix

Problem

I investigated how model and client configuration inherit shared sampling parameters. Another contributor had already opened the original issue. My role was to turn that report into an executable contract and a clear reproducer.

Decision and role

I proposed a boundary around explicit model/client overrides. The maintainer instead chose the client boundary: another model on the same server retains shared parameters, while a separate client gets its own. This is a different implementation and a refined contract, not a merge of my patch.

Validation

My proposed-contract matrix moved from 11 failing and seven passing scenarios to 18 passing. Those are scenarios, not distinct defects. The maintainer separately credited the reproduction and investigation. These tests did not establish live inference or training behavior.

What I carry forward

A contribution can shape a maintainer decision even when the proposed patch is not the accepted code.

External outcome boundary

Maintainer credits our reproduction and investigation. Our proposed patch was superseded, not merged; the original issue was filed by another contributor. No employment or payment claimed.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Our proposal

3. Maintainer implementation

4. Maintainer implementation

5. Detailed case

03 M7 MCP

2026-10-29 · Audit credited in release

Problem

I reviewed a specific MCP-server snapshot: phase transitions, repeated calls, state persistence and handoff. The audit required separating contract defects from observer mistakes and environment limitations.

Decision and role

I documented reproducible observations with inputs, causes and limits. Maintainers built their own issue registry and implemented the first maintenance release. Their registry entries are not a one-to-one copy of the audit groups.

Validation

The original public PDF is retained unchanged rather than rewritten around a later release. A focused follow-up on a pinned commit passed 168 tests and an SDK stdio check while retaining three unresolved error paths. It was not a complete reaudit.

What I carry forward

An audit should leave a checkable route to each failure and retain what a later release has not established.

External outcome boundary

Public review/triage attribution and maintainer maintenance release. Audit groups and maintainer registry entries are not interchangeable. Focused follow-up retained unresolved error paths; no live model or IDE evaluation.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Detailed case

04 Braintrust SDK JavaScript

2026-11-02 · Direct PR merged · 2026-11-02T11:37:30Z

Problem

The failure occurred at logging chunk boundaries: a multibyte UTF-8 character can span two byte chunks. Correct text should not depend on how a transport partitions its stream.

Decision and role

I retained decoder state between reads and separated final flushing from intermediate chunks. Testing every byte boundary made the invariant concrete: different partitions of one byte stream must produce the same text.

Validation

The first focused run had six failures and 13 passing controls. Related suites passed 178 tests on both tested Node versions. These are local checks of selected paths, not the entire monorepo, browser execution or a real-provider end-to-end test.

What I carry forward

Chunk boundaries belong to the transport. Decoder state must belong to the complete logical stream.

External outcome boundary

Merged streaming UTF-8 logging fix with local regression coverage; no full monorepo, browser or real-provider end-to-end claim.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Detailed case

05 Kraft

2026-11-02 · Direct PR merged · 2026-11-02T12:08:30Z

Problem

Repeated user-scope initialization detected an existing MCP registration and returned before refreshing skills. The command appeared repeatable, but its second responsibility was skipped.

Decision and role

I separated a successfully existing registration from a genuine subprocess failure. The former allows skill refresh to proceed; the latter must stop before writes. The change repairs control flow without invoking a live agent.

Validation

The focused suite passed 16 tests. Repository ci-checks and mutation checks exercised the distinction between branches. The Claude subprocess was a test double; those checks did not change user configuration or call an external agent.

What I carry forward

Repeated initialization should repeat useful work rather than mistake an idempotent state for failure.

External outcome boundary

Merged repeatable user-scope initialization fix. Tests used a Claude subprocess double, without live agent calls or user-configuration changes.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Detailed case

06 PyTorch TensorDict

2026-11-01 · Incorporated into a merged maintainer fix

Problem

A partial checkpoint in a nested TensorDictParams could fail despite strict=False. I examined missing keys, nesting, assignment and pre-hooks: behavior that PyTorch users already rely on.

Decision and role

I proposed a loader repair and differential controls against native nn.Module. The maintainer chose a smaller owner-level change: delegate to PyTorch rather than maintain a copy. The public credit covers the earlier fix, report and thorough tests.

Validation

Our candidate had 44 failing scenarios and four passing controls on the base; its focused suites then passed 251 tests with two CUDA skips. Those counts do not describe the maintainer implementation, whose acceptance is recorded by a separate upstream PR.

What I carry forward

When a lower layer already owns the contract, delegation can be stronger than a more accurate copy.

External outcome boundary

Maintainer credits the earlier proposed fix, report and thorough tests. Our PR #3426 was superseded, not merged; the smaller accepted implementation is the maintainer's.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Our proposal

3. Acknowledgement

4. Detailed case

07 BlackJAX

2026-11-02 · Direct PR merged · 2026-11-02T14:43:52Z

Problem

Barker MCMC could reject an improving move because an intermediate exp overflowed. The final log expression remained mathematically finite, but direct evaluation lost it.

Decision and role

I replaced unstable log(1+exp(x)) evaluation with standard softplus. The important proof was not merely absence of inf, but the correct proposal probability against an independent density calculation. Ordinary inputs remained controls.

Validation

Across 768 CPU steps, the NumPy oracle found 142 base mismatches and none after the change; all 384 ordinary controls already passed. The full suite was not run. An unchanged GIST CI failure was reproduced on base and head; no GPU, TPU or speed-up is claimed.

What I carry forward

Stabilize the intermediate computation while preserving the mathematical quantity and control regimes.

External outcome boundary

Merged Barker MCMC numerical-stability fix with CPU differential checks. Full suite not run; unchanged GIST CI failure reproduced on exact base and head. No GPU/TPU or performance claim.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Detailed case

08 TensorLy

2026-11-03 · Direct PR merged · 2026-11-02T23:54:45Z

Problem

A single-factor Khatri-Rao product returned its matrix before applying optional column weights and a row mask. The same path can remain after skip_matrix, silently violating the operation contract and affecting weighted CP gradients.

Decision and role

Both tenalg implementations now apply weights and mask before returning the single factor. Following JeanKossaifi's review, added coverage was reduced to one compact regression with literal expected values. The maintainer merged our PR rather than replacing it with a different implementation.

Validation

For matrix [[1,2,3],[4,5,6]], weights [2,0,-1] and mask [0,2], the expected output is [[0,0,0],[16,0,-12]]. The regression fails on the exact base across NumPy/PyTorch and core/einsum and catches independently dropping weights or mask. Before submission, both relevant modules passed 70 tests in each mode; Black checked 156 files. No runtime tests were repeated merely to record the merge.

What I carry forward

One carefully chosen example can cover both required multipliers without a grid of near-duplicate tests. The maintainer’s request for simpler coverage became part of the accepted contribution.

External outcome boundary

Our PR merged. The compact regression and two relevant modules were checked on CPU with NumPy/PyTorch and core/einsum (70 tests per run). The full repository, GPU and remaining backend/version matrix were not run; the earlier large oracle campaign was not repeated for the test-only revision.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Acknowledgement

3. Detailed case

09 Apache TVM-FFI

2026-11-03 · Incorporated into a merged maintainer fix

Problem

Equal short byte values with inline and heap storage received different structural hashes, violating expectations of StructuralKey cache lookup and native map deduplication. My proposed patch repaired both hashing paths.

Decision and role

The maintainer publicly linked the proposal to a successor and chose another layer: a short moved std::string directly constructs inline String/Bytes. The changed file sets are disjoint; no direct patch transplant was found in the inspected diffs. Successor PR #898 merged on 2 November 2026 at 22:16:16 UTC; our proposal remains superseded.

Validation

Native PR states, chronology, commits and diffs were compared. The constructor-side change removes the producer path used by the original reproducer. The successor and all explicit external-heap cases were not runtime-retested for this record.

What I carry forward

A reproduction can lead to another repair. Superseded and merged are different external outcomes.

External outcome boundary

Our PR #897 was superseded, not merged. The publicly linked maintainer replacement #898 merged, changing short moved-string construction instead of transplanting our hashing patch. The replacement and all explicit external-heap scenarios were not runtime-retested for this record.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Our proposal

3. Acknowledgement

4. Detailed case

10 CodinGame - Mad Pod Racing

2026-10-21 (Europe/Helsinki) · Dated arena snapshot · UTC 2026-10-20T22:06:15.975Z · 86/1657 (Legend League)

Problem

I developed a bot for a continuous arena, where a local win does not establish an external rank. The record preserves two experiments: early rejection of a hypothesis and a conditional local candidate after criteria changed.

Decision and role

V79 stopped after two wins in eight completed games because the required threshold was no longer reachable. V89b recorded 221/400, but criteria changed after earlier failures, so I do not treat it as an independent clean win or an officially submitted version.

Validation

The external league snapshot has its own public source and dated screenshot. The local extract omits candidate code, referee and full traces; hashes alone cannot reproduce the matches or independently attest to their contents.

What I carry forward

A stopping rule protects against proving a desired outcome. Local experiments and external arenas have different units of evidence.

External outcome boundary

Dated league ranking snapshot, not a final tournament result or an all-time best.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Arena profile

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2026-10-19 (Europe/Helsinki) · Historical preliminary result · UTC 2026-10-20T22:06:05.463Z · 5/9 (overall preliminary score of second-stage participants)

2026-10-27 (Europe/Helsinki) · Season prize winner; exact rank not established

Problem

This case retains two observations of one tournament. A preliminary second-stage table and a later organizer announcement describe different levels of completion. I do not count them as independent tournament outcomes.

Decision and role

My engineering role was development and validation of my bot and preservation of external evidence boundaries. A code-level engineering report is not yet public, so this book does not invent algorithm or autonomy claims.

Validation

The preliminary table excluded R3. The organizer later named the account among prize winners. The date the announcement was checked is not its publication date; exact final placement and payment are not established here.

What I carry forward

History should retain a preliminary state without turning it into another victory.

External outcome boundary

Public table excludes episode R3; no final placement, award or payment claimed.

Organizer names this account among five prize winners. This record does not establish an exact final rank, a ranked participant count or payment.

Sources

1. Primary source

2. Primary source

A growing record

For each new result I retain the UTC observation date, my role, primary source and exact external disposition. Old reproductions remain dated; a follow-up is not a complete reaudit. I append results.json, add narrative to book/narrative.json and run the build and offline check.

Build sources

results.json:
d2c8bb73569e37f0cc505043599767a7864c81e4bf3a8fbeec0a1cd98e4b55e0

book/narrative.json:
8a9400ca1b73408b9191ccd9487018bdb338c08754cab9eeea67c69908c24d65

Detailed bilingual reports and the unchanged historical M7 audit are available in the repository.

github.com/DiadkoShmek/engineering-results